Day 23 (stop 2 of 2) - Rockside

Bruce Trail side-trail plan (dog-friendly, max ~8 mi) · Toronto section · hike 31 · Cheltenham

3.0 km / 1.9 mi	~0.8 h	1.1 km new	44 min
total walking	hiking, plus stops	side trail covered	drive from home, Sat 7 am

Park (P): Roadside parking at Boston Mills Rd just west of the Mississauga Rd intersection. Note: driveway is private property. Google Maps. **Free**

Navigate: import *day23b_hike031.gpx* into Gaia GPS. The track is the whole route in walking order, and the J waypoints match the directions below.

Side trails covered: Rockside Side Trail (1.1 km)

Same day: this is stop 2 of 2 on day 23 (6.4 mi of hiking, about 108 min total driving). Other stop(s): stop 1: hike 30, 4.6 mi from Limehouse Conservation Area.

Route map



What to expect

- **Parking:** Roadside on Boston Mills Rd just west of Mississauga Rd. The driveway there is private property; do not block it.
- **Route:** A short out-and-back on the main Bruce Trail with the Rockside Side Trail, near the end of the Toronto Section. No description of the Rockside Side Trail itself was found.
- **Main trail nearby:** A trip report describes the main trail in this area crossing a valley, climbing the escarpment, following its brow for about 1 km, then climbing a secondary escarpment into mature woods. Expect a climb and some edge walking; keep Zappy on a short lead near the brow.
- **Cheltenham Badlands:** The Toronto Section ends near these Queenston Shale badlands, now viewed from a boardwalk. Visitors leaving the trail worsened the erosion, so stay on the path if you visit.

Parking options

	Alternative parking	Parking cost	Route km	Walk to trail	Closest side trails
P2	Roadside parking where the main Trail meets Heritage Rd map	Free	1.5	980 m	

Parking costs were checked in October 2026 from operator websites and Bruce Trail Conservancy data; prices and booking rules change, so check before you go.

Turn-by-turn

km	mi	Directions
0.0	0.0	Start at the parking: Roadside parking at Boston Mills Rd just west of the Mississauga Rd intersection. Walk about 40 m to the trail. Head south-west on the white-blazed main Bruce Trail. The next 0.2 km follows an unopened road allowance (rough track, no traffic).

0.4	0.2	J1: Continue straight onto the blue-blazed Rockside Side Trail, heading south-west. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your left.)
0.7	0.5	Heads-up: The next 1.6 km follows an unopened road allowance (rough track, no traffic).
1.5	0.9	J2: Turnaround point. Turn around and retrace your steps.
2.6	1.6	J1: Continue straight onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading north-east. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your right.)
2.8	1.8	Heads-up: The next 0.2 km follows an unopened road allowance (rough track, no traffic).
3.0	1.9	Leave the trail and walk back to the parking. Hike complete.

Distances and junctions are computed from the Bruce Trail Conservancy's trail data (Bruce County GIS). Left/right is calculated from the trail geometry. Use it as a guide, follow the blazes, and check the Conservancy's trail-change notices before you go. Dogs must be leashed everywhere on the Bruce Trail. Trail descriptions draw on a Vanderplas family trip report and Hiking the GTA.